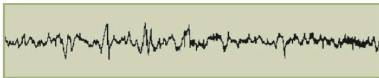
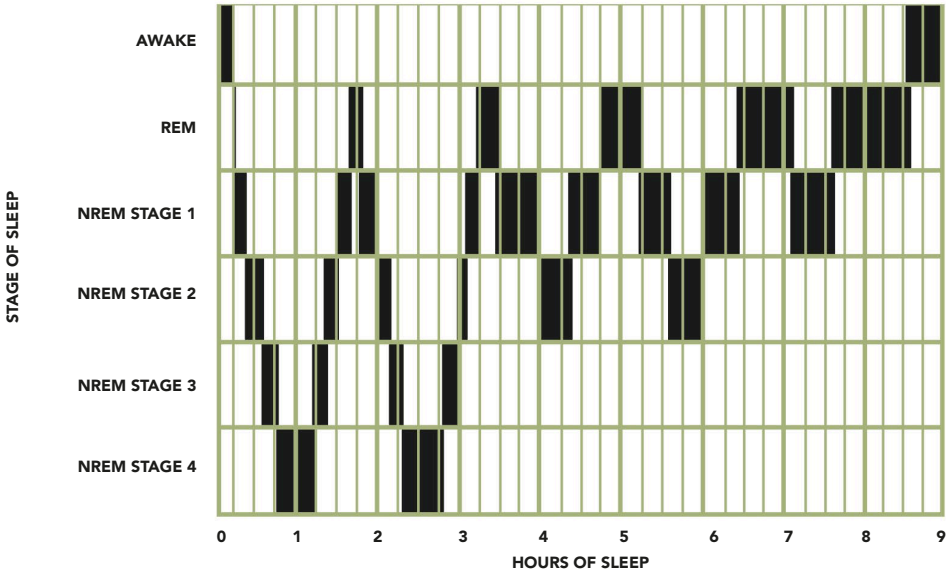


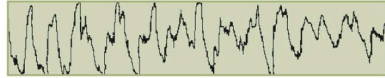
SLEEP CYCLES

During sleep, much of the body rests, but not the brain. Its billions of neurons continue to send signals, as shown by EEG traces. Sleep occurs in cycles, which are made up of lengthening phases of REM (rapid eye movement) sleep, when most dreaming occurs, and four stages of NREM

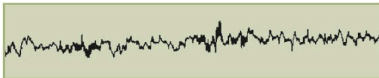
(non-rapid eye movement sleep), which is mostly dreamless. In stage 1, sleep is light: people wake relatively easily, and brain waves are active. In stage 2, brain waves begin to slow down. In stage 3, fast and slow waves are interspersed. In stage 4, the deepest stage, there are slow waves only.



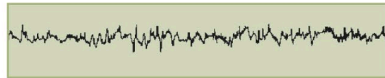
NREM SLEEP: STAGE 1



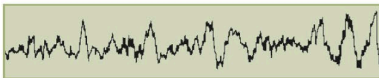
NREM SLEEP: STAGE 4



NREM SLEEP: STAGE 2



REM SLEEP



NREM SLEEP: STAGE 3

SLEEP STAGES

EEG traces show different waveforms of brain activity for each sleep stage. As the body reaches the deeper stages, body temperature, heart rate, breathing rate, and blood pressure all reduce. During REM sleep, these functions increase slightly and most dreaming occurs.